PRIN 2026 PROJECT

PRESERVE

Preserving Developer Intent in Trustworthy AI-Assisted Software Engineering

AI writes the code. Who safeguards the intent?

Developers increasingly **express an intent**, and AI agents turn it into software. PRESERVE is founding a new discipline, **intent engineering**, so that what we ask of AI holds true from the prompt all the way to production. And we are looking for curious minds to do it with us.

WHAT WE DO

A loop that never loses sight of intent

1

Capture

Developers and AI agents structure requirements, constraints and decisions.

2

Formalize

Intent becomes a specification, so ambiguities and contradictions surface early.

3

Verify

Generated code is continuously checked against what we actually meant.

4

Optimize & Evolve

Costs, performance and sustainability are optimized around developers' priorities.

TOPICS

What we work on

AI agents · LLMs for code · Testing & verification · Human-AI interaction · Green software · Distributed systems

JOIN US

Excited by these topics? Let's talk.

Thesis, PhD or research: get in touch with the contact person at the unit closest to you.

Fabio Palomba
University of Salerno
fpalomba@unisa.it

Simone Scalabrino
University of Molise
simone.scalabrino@unimol.it

Vittorio Cortellessa
University of L'Aquila
vittorio.cortellessa@univaq.it

Fabio Calefato
University of Bari Aldo Moro
fabio.calefato@uniba.it

Davide Falessi
University of Rome Tor Vergata
falessi@ing.uniroma2.it

Alessandro Margara
Politecnico di Milano
alessandro.margara@polimi.it

Want to shape the software of tomorrow?

Discover the project, the team and the latest news on the PRESERVE website.

preserve-prin26.github.io